leetcode.com /problems/summary-ranges/

# Image Explanation

228. Summary Ranges

Easy

Topics

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You are given a **sorted unique** integer array `nums`.

A **range** `[a,b]` is the set of all integers from a to b (inclusive).

Return *the **smallest sorted** list of ranges that **cover all the numbers in the array exactly***. That is, each element of `nums` is covered by exactly one of the ranges, and there is no integer x such that x is in one of the ranges but not in `nums`.

Each range `[a,b]` in the list should be output as:

- `"a->b"` if `a != b`
- `"a"` if `a == b`

**Example 1:**

```
Input: nums = [0,1,2,4,5,7]
Output: ["0->2","4->5","7"]
Explanation: The ranges are:
[0,2] --> "0->2"
```

```
[4,5] --> "4->5"
[7,7] --> "7"
```

**Example 2:**

```
Input: nums = [0,2,3,4,6,8,9]
Output: ["0","2->4","6","8->9"]
Explanation: The ranges are:
[0,0] --> "0"
[2,4] --> "2->4"
[6,6] --> "6"
[8,9] --> "8->9"
```

**Constraints:**

- `0 <= nums.length <= 20`
- $-2^{31} <= nums[i] <= 2^{31} - 1$
- All the values of `nums` are **unique**.
- `nums` is sorted in ascending order.

Seen this question in a real interview before?

1/5

Yes

No

Accepted

933,067/1.7M

Acceptance Rate

54.1%

Topics

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Discussion (166)

💡 Discussion Rules

1. Please don't post **any solutions** in this discussion.

2. The problem discussion is for asking questions about the problem or for sharing tips - anything except for solutions.

3. If you'd like to share your solution for feedback and ideas, please head to the solutions tab and post it there.

Shivam Aggarwal

Jun 12, 2023

```
Input: nums = [0,2,3,4,6,8,9]
```

The problem asks us to "group" the elements of array into ranges that are continuous. That is, in one range their should not be any number absent in array. And we need to minimize the different ranges we use, so try to take as big range as possible. At each element, make a different range only when you find some number absent in between current and last element, otherwise expand the current range by 1.

```
Output: ["0","2->4","6","8->9"]
```

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Jack Li

Oct 21, 2015

I don't really understand what this question is asking. It says return the summary of its ranges but the what does this mean?

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An-Wen Deng

Jun 11, 2023

This is an easy question. But test this test case before submitting, especially for the C/C++ programmer!

```
[-2147483648,-2147483647,2147483647]
```

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District_12

Dec 28, 2022

Why not ["0-7"] as a result? What do you need? Problem description is so bad.

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Batman

Nov 11, 2018

All submissions are the exact same. A couple ms makes a huge difference in how fast your submission is judged so resubmit a couple times to be sure your solution isn't actually slow :)

32ms = you beat 100%
52ms = you beat 10%

lol

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Timur

Sep 09, 2023

Dislike for confusing test case [2; -1]

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antoxakartoxa

Sep 03, 2023

In the task description there is "nums is sorted in ascending order". But one of testcases checked after submission is [2, -1] which is descending order.

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Mayank Singh

Feb 27, 2022

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hokilpet

Apr 10, 2024

Try these cases before submitting:
[-2147483648,-2147483647,2147483647]
[]
[-1]
[-5,-4,-2,-1,0,1,2]

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mindstrong

Jul 11, 2015

I can not understand what does this question is. the example show's none principles to summarize the ranges. why [0,1,2,4,5,7] should be summarized to ["0->2", "4->5", "7"], why not ["0-1", "2->5", "7"?

who can explain this question more clearly ? thank you in advance.

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